

5. Project Development Phase

In the development phase, the planned solution was implemented on the ServiceNow platform. The project focuses on creating a structured Incident Management process and supporting it with ServiceNow configuration and automation.

5.1 ServiceNow Environment Setup

- Used a ServiceNow development/practice instance.
- Configured the required users, groups and roles.
- Used the Incident table and related ServiceNow functionality.

5.2 Incident Record Creation

Incident records were created to represent IT issues reported by users. Each record contains the information required to identify, classify, prioritize and assign the issue.

5.3 Incident Classification and Prioritization

Incidents were classified using fields such as category and subcategory. Impact and urgency are used to determine the appropriate priority so that critical issues can receive suitable attention.

5.4 Assignment and Investigation

After classification, incidents are assigned to the appropriate support group and, when required, to an individual. Support users can record investigation details through work notes and communicate with the caller using additional comments.

5.5 Resolution and Closure

Once the technical issue is resolved, resolution information is recorded and the incident moves through the appropriate resolution and closure stages. This provides a complete history of the incident.

5.6 Knowledge Management Integration

Knowledge Management supports the incident process by providing reusable solutions for known issues. Support teams can use relevant knowledge articles to reduce investigation time and improve consistency in incident resolution.

5.7 Change Management Integration

When an incident requires a system or infrastructure change, Change Management can be used to ensure that the change is planned, controlled and tracked. This helps reduce risk while resolving the underlying issue.

5.8 Testing

- Created test incident records.
- Verified required incident information was captured.
- Verified classification and prioritization.
- Verified assignment to support groups/users.
- Verified incident state/lifecycle progression.
- Verified resolution and closure information.
- Verified supporting Knowledge Management functionality.
- Verified Change Management usage where applicable.

5.9 Final Outcome

The completed project demonstrates an Incident Lifecycle Automation solution in ServiceNow. The solution provides a structured process from incident creation to resolution and supports faster and more consistent IT service operations through automation, knowledge reuse and controlled change management.

Project Screenshots – Development Evidence

The following screenshots provide visual evidence of the ServiceNow implementation performed for the Incident Lifecycle Automation project.

5.2.1 Incident Record – Details View

This screenshot shows incident INC0010048 in the Service Operations Workspace. It contains the short description, detailed description, state, caller, activity area, and SLA information.

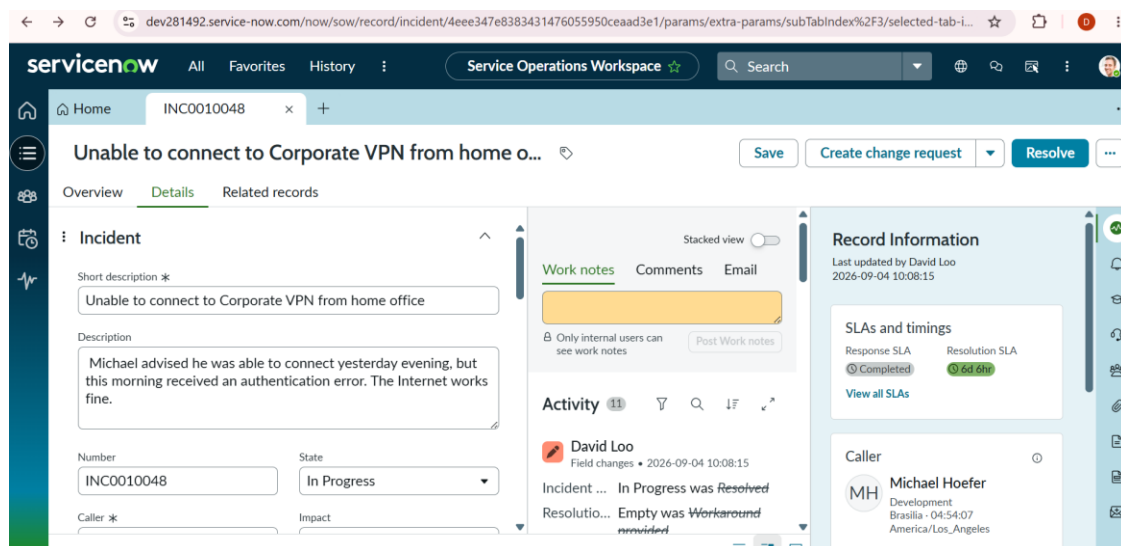


Figure 1: Incident INC0010048 – Details and SLA information.

5.2.2 Incident Overview

This screenshot shows the Overview tab for incident INC0010048, including the incident summary, priority, impact, urgency, activity history, and SLA details.

The screenshot displays the ServiceNow interface for incident INC0010048. The top navigation bar includes 'Home', 'INC0010048', and a search bar. The incident title is 'Unable to connect to Corporate VPN from home o...'. Below the title, there are tabs for 'Overview', 'Details', and 'Related records'. The 'Overview' tab is active, showing a 'Summary' section with a short description and a detailed description. The incident is categorized with a priority of '4 - Low', an impact of '3 - Low', and an urgency of '3 - Medium'. The 'Activity' section shows a log of events, including a field change by David Loo. The 'Record Information' section provides details on SLAs and timings, and identifies the caller as Michael Hoefer.

Field	Value
Number	INC0010048
Priority	4 - Low
Opened	2026-09-04 02:58:48
State	3 - Low
Urgency	3 - Medium

Figure 2: Incident INC0010048 – Overview and activity.

5.2.3 Child Incident Record

This screenshot shows child incident INC0010053 created for the Corporate VPN connectivity issue. It demonstrates a separate incident record with its own description, priority, caller, and assignment information.

The screenshot shows the ServiceNow interface for child incident INC0010053. The top navigation bar includes 'Home', 'INC0010048', and a search bar. The incident title is 'Unable to connect to Corporate VPN'. Below the title, there are tabs for 'Overview', 'Details', and 'Related records'. The 'Overview' tab is active, showing a 'Summary' section with a short description and a detailed description. The incident is categorized with a priority of '5 - Planning', an impact of '3 - Low', and an urgency of '3 - Medium'. The 'Activity' section shows a log of events, including a field change by System Administrator. The 'Record Information' section provides details on SLAs and timings, and identifies the caller as System Administrator.

Field	Value
Number	INC0010053
Priority	5 - Planning
Opened	2026-09-04 08:50:37
State	3 - Low
Urgency	3 - Medium

Figure 3: Child incident INC0010053 – Corporate VPN issue.

Screenshot Evidence Mapping

Screenshot	ServiceNow Evidence	Development Activity
Figure 1	INC0010048 Details	Incident record details, state, activity and SLA
Figure 2	INC0010048 Overview	Incident summary, priority, impact and urgency
Figure 3	INC0010053	Child incident creation and record details

Conclusion

The Incident Lifecycle Automation in ServiceNow project demonstrates how ServiceNow can be used to manage IT incidents through a standardized lifecycle. The project covers ideation, requirements, solution design, planning and development. It also demonstrates the relationship between Incident Management, Knowledge Management and Change Management in improving IT service efficiency.